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# The generator mistake that kills families

1. **Never indoors.** Not in the house, garage, basement, crawlspace or shed, even with doors and windows open.
2. **20 feet out.** Run it outside at least 20 feet from the house, exhaust pointed away from doors, windows and vents.
3. **No backfeeding.** Never plug a generator into a wall outlet. Use heavy-duty outdoor cords or a transfer switch installed by an electrician.
4. **CO alarms.** Battery or battery-backup CO alarms on every level and outside sleeping areas. Test them.
5. **Symptoms.** Headache, dizziness, weakness, nausea, confusion. Get to fresh air and call 911.
6. **Fuel.** Turn it off and let it cool before refueling. Store fuel outside living areas.

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## Go deeper: The Human Backup Plan

View on Amazon: https://www.amazon.com/dp/B0HD545NVD

**Sources:**

CDC: Carbon monoxide and generators - https://www.cdc.gov/carbon-monoxide/about/index.html
Ready.gov: Power outages - https://www.ready.gov/power-outages

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